

Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:—

Increase of amount of loans which may be guaranteed under 11 & 12 Geo. 5. c. 65, and extension of period for giving guarantees.

1.—(1) The maximum limit on the aggregate capital amount of the loans, the principal or interest of which may be guaranteed under subsection (1) of section one of the Trade Facilities Act, 1921, as amended by any other enactment, shall be increased from seventy million pounds to seventy-five million pounds.

(2) The period within which guarantees may be given under the said section one (which period as now limited will expire on the thirty-first day of March, nineteen hundred and twenty-six) shall be extended by one year.

Extension of periods during which guarantees may be given and remain in force under Overseas Trade Acts, 1920 to 1924.

2. The period within which new guarantees may be given under the Overseas Trade Acts, 1920 to 1924, and the period during which guarantees given under the said Acts (including renewed guarantees) may remain in force, shall be extended by three years so as to expire on the eighth day of September, nineteen hundred and twenty-nine, and the eighth day of September, nineteen hundred and thirty-three, respectively.

Short title.

3. This Act may be cited as the Trade Facilities Act, 1926, and the Trade Facilities Acts, 1921 to 1925, and section one of this Act may be cited together as the Trade Facilities Acts, 1921 to 1926, and the Overseas Trade Acts, 1920 to 1924, and section two of this Act may be cited together as the Overseas Trade Acts, 1920 to 1926.

CHAPTER 4.

An Act to confirm and give effect to an agreement made between the Treasury and the Ministry of Finance for Northern Ireland with a view to assimilating the burdens on the Exchequers of the United Kingdom and Northern Ireland with respect to unemployment insurance.

[26th March 1926.]

WHEREAS, with a view to assimilating the burdens on the Exchequer of the United Kingdom and the Exchequer of Northern Ireland, per head of population, in respect of unemployment insurance, the Treasury

and the Ministry of Finance for Northern Ireland have entered into the agreement set forth in the schedule to this Act, and it is expedient that the said agreement should be confirmed and that provision should be made for the payment of such sums as may be payable out of the Exchequer of the United Kingdom thereunder :

Be it therefore enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:—

1.—(1) The agreement set forth in the schedule to this Act is hereby confirmed, and shall have effect as if enacted in this Act.

Confirma-
tion of
scheduled
agreement.

(2) Any sums certified by the Joint Exchequer Board to be payable under the said agreement from the Exchequer of the United Kingdom to the Exchequer of Northern Ireland shall be charged on and paid out of the Consolidated Fund of the United Kingdom or the growing produce thereof.

2.—(1) This Act may be cited as the Unemployment Insurance (Northern Ireland Agreement) Act, 1926.

Short title,
commence-
ment and
duration.

(2) This Act shall not come into operation unless and until His Majesty, by Order in Council, declares that a corresponding Act has been passed by the Parliament of Northern Ireland, and shall cease to be in force if and when His Majesty, by Order in Council, declares that such corresponding Act of the Parliament of Northern Ireland has ceased to be in force.

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SCHEDULE.

AGREEMENT MADE BETWEEN THE TREASURY AND THE MINISTRY OF FINANCE FOR NORTHERN IRELAND WITH A VIEW TO ASSIMILATING THE BURDENS ON THE EXCHEQUER OF THE UNITED KINGDOM AND ON THE EXCHEQUER OF NORTHERN IRELAND IN RESPECT OF UNEMPLOYMENT INSURANCE. . .

The Treasury and the Ministry of Finance for Northern Ireland, with a view to assimilating the burdens on the Exchequer of the United Kingdom and the Exchequer of Northern Ireland, per head of populations, in respect of unemployment insurance, have entered into the following agreement :

1. There shall in respect of each financial year be ascertained the surplus or deficiency of the unemployment funds of Great Britain and Northern Ireland, and the amount required to be paid into the fund which is, as compared with the other fund, in the less favourable position, in order to bring the funds into a state of parity in respect of that year, on the basis of the insured populations of Great Britain and Northern Ireland, respectively.

The fund which is in the less favourable position is hereinafter referred to as "the poorer fund."

The payment required to be made into the poorer fund in order to bring it into such a state of parity as aforesaid is hereinafter referred to as "the equalisation payment."

The surplus or deficiency of an unemployment fund in respect of any financial year shall be ascertained by comparing the receipts of the fund on income account in that year, excluding any sums paid into the fund during the year on account of the equalisation payment under this agreement or by way of advances from the Exchequer, with the expenditure from the fund on income account in the year, including the amount paid for that year by way of interest on advances from the Exchequer made to that fund in that or any previous year and for the time being outstanding, but excluding any sums paid by way of repayment of advances from the Exchequer.

2. If as respects any year there is paid into the poorer fund by way of grant from the Exchequer of the country to which that fund belongs, in addition to any other contributions payable into that fund from that Exchequer, an amount equal to the equalisation payment, there shall be paid into that Exchequer from the Exchequer of the other country, a contribution calculated in manner hereinafter appearing.

3. The contribution from one Exchequer to the other in respect of a financial year shall be a sum equal to three-fourths of such sum as may be required to equalise per head of the population of the respective countries the payments from the Exchequers of the respective countries into their respective unemployment funds in respect of that year (excluding any payments on account of advances from those Exchequers to their respective unemployment funds but including, in the case of the country to which the poorer fund belongs, the amount of the equalisation payment).

4. There may be paid from time to time from the Exchequer of the country to which an unemployment fund belongs into that fund sums on account of the equalisation payment which may ultimately be found to be due to that fund, and where any such payment on account is made from an Exchequer, there shall be paid to that Exchequer from the Exchequer of the other country on account of the contribution which may ultimately be found to be due such sum as the Joint Exchequer Board may determine to be proper.

5. If at any time the classes of persons insured, the rates of contribution or the rates or conditions of benefit differ in the two countries, there shall be made such adjustments in the amount of the equalisation payment and the contribution from one Exchequer to the other as the Joint Exchequer Board, after consulting the Government Actuary, consider just.

6.—(1) If at any time the proportion of the receipts of an unemployment fund which may be applied as an appropriation in aid of moneys provided by Parliament for the purpose of administrative expenses differs in the two countries, and by reason thereof the proportion of the receipts so applied in one country exceeds the amount which might have been so applied if the proportions had been the same, the amount of such excess shall, for the purpose of determining the surplus or deficiency of that fund, not be treated as expenditure from that fund.

(2) The sums paid into an unemployment fund on account of the equalisation payment under this agreement shall not be treated as receipts of the fund in determining the amount which may be paid as an appropriation in aid of moneys provided by Parliament for the purpose of administrative expenses.

7. Any question arising under this agreement as to the amount of any equalisation payment or of a contribution from one Exchequer to the other, or otherwise, shall be determined by the Joint Exchequer Board, whose decision shall be final.

8. For the purposes of this agreement in relation to any financial year—

(a) the populations of Great Britain and Northern Ireland respectively shall be deemed to be such as may be

certified by the Registrar-General, after consultation with the Registrar-General for Scotland, and by the Registrar-General of Northern Ireland, respectively, to be in their opinion the population on the thirtieth day of June in that year;

- (b) the expression "insured population" means the number of persons certified by the Minister of Labour and the Ministry of Labour for Northern Ireland, respectively, with the concurrence of the Government Actuary as being in their opinion the number of persons insured under the enactments relating to unemployment insurance in Great Britain and Northern Ireland, respectively, on the thirtieth day of June in that year (excluding persons insured under any special scheme made under any of those enactments).

9. This agreement shall not come into operation until confirmed by Acts of the Parliaments of the United Kingdom and Northern Ireland, but upon being so confirmed shall apply as from the first day of October, nineteen hundred and twenty-five, until the thirty-first day of March, nineteen hundred and thirty.

10. For the purposes of this agreement, the period from the first day of October, nineteen hundred and twenty-five, to the thirty-first day of March, nineteen hundred and twenty-six, shall be deemed to be a financial year; and in relation to that period the period from the first day of April to the thirtieth day of September, nineteen hundred and twenty-five, shall be deemed to be a previous year, and references in paragraphs (a) and (b) of Article 8 of this agreement to the thirtieth day of June in a year shall be construed as references to the thirtieth day of June nineteen hundred and twenty-five.

(Signed) H. M. POLLOCK.

(Signed) WINSTON S. CHURCHILL.

FREDERICK CHARLES

THOMSON.

10th February 1926.

